ISO 20121 Event sustainability management system

Service information sheet. ISO Management Systems. Information checked 11 October 2026.

In brief

ISO 20121 is the international standard for event sustainability management systems. It helps organisers and venues reduce environmental and social impacts while delivering successful events. ICFC supports implementation, audits and training.

What it is

ISO 20121 sets requirements for an event sustainability management system covering environmental, social and economic impacts of events.

Who it is for

Event organisers, venues, MICE companies and suppliers to the events industry.

How ICFC helps

Service	What we offer
Audit	Third-party audits: Third-party certification audits for ISO 20121 are delivered by our auditors on behalf of accredited certification bodies. The certificate is issued by the certification body, not by ICFC. Second-party audits: Supplier and partner audits against ISO 20121 on behalf of your organisation, with clear findings you can act on. Internal audits: First-party internal audits of your event sustainability management by experienced auditors, combinable with other standards in one integrated audit.
Consulting	Funding: We explain which scheme, if any, applies and what it requires before you commit. Non-grant: A fixed-scope engagement: gap assessment, documentation, implementation coaching, internal audit and management review, and support through the formal audit or assessment. How we work: Practical, proportionate systems that your staff can run after we leave.
Training	Classroom: Public and in-house classroom courses on ISO 20121: awareness, implementation and internal auditor levels. Online LMS: Self-paced and live-online courses on the ICFC Digital LMS, with progress tracking and certificates of completion. Funding: Funding depends on each course's approval status, shown on the course page in the LMS.

Funding

Not on the EDGE Standards list. We did not find this standard on the EDGE Standards list when we checked. Ask us about non-grant options or other schemes that may apply.

Impartiality

Impartiality comes first. Every engagement begins with a conflict-of-interest check. We keep consulting and auditing roles separate, and our auditors never audit, on behalf of a certification body, an organisation that ICFC has consulted on the same scope within the period set by that body.

Frequently asked questions

Q. Does ISO 20121 cover one event or our whole business?
A. It is a management system, so it can cover a single event or your organisation's ongoing event activities.

Q. Is ISO 20121 on EDGE?
A. We did not find ISO 20121 on the EDGE Standards list when we checked. Ask us about other options.

Q. Does it link to ISO 20400?
A. Yes. Sustainable procurement is central to responsible events.

Q. Is it relevant to venues?
A. Yes. Venues and suppliers often adopt it to support clients' sustainability goals.

Related services

- ISO 20400 Sustainable procurement (guidance)
- ISO 26000 Guidance on social responsibility
- ISO 14001 Environmental Management System (EMS)
- Sustainability reporting assessment (training only)

Talk to us

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